

INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGES

OVERVIEW

In courses in international languages, students develop their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills in order to communicate in the language of study (the target language) in a variety of contexts and for a variety of purposes, with a focus on real-life situations and uses. Through their exploration of a wide variety of authentic materials and meaningful activities, students develop not only language skills but also the skills necessary for lifelong language learning. They also acquire an understanding and appreciation of diverse communities around the world where the target language is spoken, and make connections to their own community.

Language structures and conventions that are appropriate for each level are listed in the Language Knowledge chart for international languages that is provided in Appendix B. Students should be given ample opportunities to demonstrate and extend their understanding of the language elements by applying them in a wide variety of contexts across the strands. Two additional charts are provided to assist teachers in planning learning activities – Topics for Developing Vocabulary, and Cultural Concepts for Developing Intercultural Understanding.

The expectations for courses in international languages are organized into four distinct but related strands:

Listening

Oral communication skills lay the foundation for the acquisition of any new language, and pave the way for learning to read and write in that language. Well-developed listening skills are essential for students' development of the proficiency in the target language that they will need to succeed in the program. To develop their listening and interaction skills, international language learners need extensive opportunities to listen to and interact with others. They also need to develop listening skills in order to understand what is said during classroom presentations, in radio and television broadcasts, and in many other contexts. At first, students listen to directions and instructions; as they progress, they are able to take point-form notes in class; and eventually, they are able to provide a summary of a presentation.

International language learners need many opportunities to listen to a range of subjects, including topics that interest them, concepts in school subjects, and contemporary issues. Students listen to words, phrases, and passages in the target language in order to identify standard pronunciation and to improve their reading comprehension. Students listen to explanations of language structures and conventions and cultural concepts. They also

listen to a wide range of oral texts representing formal and informal social registers and various genres and forms appropriate to their interests (e.g., podcasts, videos, song lyrics, radio shows, electronic sources, poetry, short stories, advertisements, video games, radio shows). They also need exposure to oral texts of increasing difficulty in the target language, such as longer radio broadcasts or documentaries on more complex topics.

It is important that teachers contextualize listening interactions and activities for students. This can be done through brainstorming to identify what students already know about the topic of a new text they are about to hear or view. Some examples of richly integrated tasks are: discussing strategies for organizing ideas for a writing assignment; presenting and defending ideas or debating current issues; and offering constructive and descriptive feedback about work produced by their peers.

Speaking

Oral language is a fundamental means of communicating with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Students build a broad range of speaking skills, both for conversational purposes and for academic purposes, such as presenting ideas and information to their classmates. At first, students engage in brief conversations on everyday topics; as they progress, they engage in speaking tasks such as sharing ideas about a variety of texts in a literature circle; and eventually, they are able to present classroom seminars or participate in debates.

International language learners need rich and frequent opportunities to speak and interact in the classroom in a purposeful way – for example, through collaborative learning in pairs and small groups that allows them to engage in speaking and listening for real-life purposes. Through multiple opportunities to speak in various groupings, students begin to communicate effectively and to gain confidence as they explore ideas and concepts, identify and solve problems, organize information, and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. An opportunity for self-reflection about their speaking skills and strategies enables students to strengthen their ability to express themselves and interact with other speakers of the target language.

It is important that teachers not only offer instruction and feedback, but also provide excellent models of the competence that a first-language speaker would demonstrate in speaking for both academic and social purposes. Teachers at all course levels should also provide modelling of various special sound features of the international language, and include instruction on norms and conventions associated with speaking the language in different cultures.

Reading

This strand provides extensive opportunities for students to build on their experience in listening to and speaking the target language to help them determine the meaning of written texts in the target language. Students read a wide variety of adapted and authentic literary, informational, and graphic texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. They activate their background knowledge, acquire vocabulary, think aloud about what they are reading, discuss texts with peers, and participate in group reading and learning activities. An effective reader not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the student must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts. The student can then understand, analyse, and absorb them and recognize their relevance in other contexts. The international languages curriculum develops the knowledge, strategies, and skills that will enable students to become effective readers in the target language.

As learners develop their reading skills in the target language, it is important that they have many opportunities to read a wide variety of texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary, become more attuned to the language structures and conventions of the target language in various genres, and increase their understanding of diverse world views.

Reading is a complex process that provides a bridge between speaking and writing. Students learning to read in the target language are also acquiring knowledge of new vocabulary and language structures, as well as a new phonological awareness of the sound system of the target language. Reading also involves the application of many comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading. Teachers need to model the use of such strategies, engage students in shared and guided exploration of texts, and foster the independent application of reading strategies. Students need to identify which strategies are personally most helpful and how they can use these and other strategies to improve as readers. For example, students might prepare before reading by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text and the vocabulary contained in that text.

During reading, students may use clues from context or from their understanding of language elements and structures to help them determine the meaning of unfamiliar words. They will also use a variety of comprehension strategies such as predicting, questioning, identifying main ideas, and monitoring comprehension to help them understand a text. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. For example, students might evaluate an author's perspective or bias in a piece of writing and discuss how that might affect the reader's interpretation.

To become fluent readers of the target language, students need to read frequently and develop the range of skills required to read for a variety of different purposes – to follow directions, to get advice, to obtain information, to build vocabulary, to obtain access to subject knowledge, and for personal interest and enjoyment.

It is important that students read a range of authentic materials illustrating the many uses of writing, since these texts will serve as models for texts that they will create. The reading program should therefore include a wide variety of literary, informational, fictional, and graphic texts – for example, short story, myth, legend, folk tale, poem, song, novel, play, report, newspaper or magazine article, television or radio script, manual, advertisements, autobiography, chart, diagram, graphic novel, comic book, recipes, and instructions.

Writing

From their experience with oral communication and reading, students acquire the skills they need to become good writers who are able to communicate ideas and opinions with ease and clarity. Current research confirms the similarity in the writing processes of both first- and second- language writers. The elements that go into writing in any language are essentially similar: selecting a topic; organizing and developing ideas to be included; choosing the form of writing and level of language appropriate to the audience and the purpose for writing; applying the conventions of written language such as grammar, spelling, punctuation, and word choice; and applying editing, revising, and proofreading strategies to produce a polished piece of writing.

However, for students who are learning a second language, the planning stage of the writing process is critical. Students must become skilled at choosing the correct vocabulary in the target language,

while selecting and organizing their ideas. They must also keep in mind the purpose for which they are writing and the audience they are addressing. To communicate clearly and effectively, they need to learn to use standard written forms and the language conventions of the target language.

Students who are beginning to write in the target language need to read a wide variety of texts that expose them to uses of vocabulary, grammatical elements, and idioms that they will need when writing their own texts. As students read a variety of written texts, they not only increase their vocabulary but also learn to vary their sentence structure, their organizational approach, and the voice they use in their writing. Students should produce a variety of forms or types of writing, such as descriptions, letters, journal entries, advertisements, brochures, summaries, reviews, dialogues, poems, short stories, questionnaires, newspaper articles, essays, and reports. Students should be given opportunities to produce interactive writing, different types of creative writing, as well as writing that addresses topics of interest to them and reflects their capacity for independent critical thought. Writing activities that are seen by students as meaningful and that challenge them to think critically and creatively will help them achieve a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing. Students' writing activities, in turn, support and reinforce both their oral language skills and their reading skills.

In addition, all students, whether they are writing in their first language or any other language, need to be taught ways to avoid plagiarism when writing for reporting and research purposes.

For more information about effective instruction in the four strands, consult the ministry resource document entitled *Adolescent Literacy Guide: A Professional Learning Resource for Literacy, Grades 7–12, 2013*.

International Languages, Level 2

University Preparation

LBACU – LDYCU

This course provides opportunities for students to increase their competence and confidence in listening, speaking, reading, and writing in the language of study. Students will communicate about academic and personally relevant topics in increasingly spontaneous spoken interactions, and will develop their creative and critical thinking skills through exploring and responding to a variety of oral and written texts. Students will continue to enrich their understanding and appreciation of diverse communities in regions of the world where the language is spoken. They will also investigate personal and professional contexts in which knowledge of the language is required, and develop skills necessary for lifelong language learning.

Prerequisite: International Languages, Level 1, Academic

A. LISTENING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. Listening to Understand:** determine meaning in a variety of oral texts in the target language, using a range of listening strategies;
- A2. Listening to Interact:** interpret messages accurately while interacting in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- A3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in oral texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

A1.1 Using Listening Comprehension

Strategies: identify a range of listening comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after listening to understand simple and complex oral texts in the target language (*e.g., use their knowledge of the structure of an oral text form to make predictions about its content before a listening task; use prior knowledge and contextual cues to deduce the meaning of unfamiliar words; listen for key words indicating sequence to help them determine when an action takes place; make jot notes during a class discussion to keep track of key ideas and supporting details*)

Teacher prompts: “What does your knowledge of the structure of the text form tell you about the possible content? What predictions can you make?” “Did this action occur before or after the other action? Which words helped you determine the sequence as you listened?”

- A1.2 Demonstrating Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and meaning of oral texts in the target language that contain information and ideas about academic and familiar topics, with contextual and visual support as appropriate (*e.g., list the main characters and their traits in an authentic folk tale read aloud; identify important points in a news report about healthy eating; extract ideas from an oral text about an environmental issue such as biodiversity or a social issue such as poverty, and categorize them by importance using a graphic organizer; summarize key ideas and outline supporting details*

in a speaker’s presentation; identify key information in a telephone message from a tourism information centre or travel agency; explain the message of an audio webcast about healthy living)

Teacher prompts: “What important details were you able to identify in the telephone message? Did they tell you everything you needed to know? If not, what was missing?” “What did you learn about health from the audio webcast? What was the main message?” “What are the main threats to biodiversity identified in this oral text? What is one solution?”

A2. Listening to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 Using Interactive Listening Strategies:

identify and use a range of interactive listening strategies to suit a variety of situations while participating in social and academic interactions in the target language (*e.g., use vocal prompts to signal empathy and interest in a conversation; ask questions and offer constructive comments to encourage a speaker to expand on a presentation; paraphrase what a peer has said, and verify the accuracy of the paraphrase with him or her; use respectful body language and an appropriate level of eye contact to encourage another speaker during a discussion; acknowledge and build on the ideas of a peer in a conversation*)

Teacher prompts: “What questions might persuade a speaker to provide more information about the topic of a presentation?” “What kinds of comments might you make to encourage a person to continue speaking?”

A2.2 Interacting: respond with understanding to what others say while participating in structured and some open-ended interactions in the target language about academic and familiar topics, with contextual and visual support as appropriate (*e.g., ask for more information in response to the statements of other students in a small-group discussion about a movie or video game; with a peer, improvise a role play about shopping for clothing; answer questions about musical, athletic, or artistic preferences when interviewed by a classmate; agree or disagree with various points of view in a small-group or class debate about an environmental issue such as water pollution or a social issue such as bullying; respond with an opinion after listening to all points of view during a discussion about the benefits of extracurricular activities; share information and opinions with a peer about purchases they made on a holiday*)

Teacher prompts: “As you prepare for the role play, think about the kinds of information that a customer needs. As the salesperson, what questions might you expect to hear? How would you respond?” “What are some of the opinions your classmates have expressed about extracurricular activities? How is your own opinion similar or different?”

A2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after listening; (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as listeners, and plan steps they can take to improve their listening skills (*e.g., keep a personal journal to reflect on ways of listening more actively during interactions; use a self-assessment checklist to monitor progress by comparing past and current listening comprehension; describe what makes a particular listening strategy effective; compare with a partner the steps they take to interpret a recorded message, and set goals to improve this strategy; plan to paraphrase what they have heard to check their understanding*)

Teacher prompts: “Think about the points in a conversation when you are listening rather than speaking. What specific improvements could you make to the skills you use?” “Think of a listening strategy you often use. What makes you choose it? What makes it useful?” “Describe the steps you take to interpret a recorded message. How could you improve them?”

A3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from oral texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., after listening to a travelogue about a country where the target language is spoken, identify and describe some significant landmarks or eco-tourism destinations; view a fictional or documentary media clip about family customs or education in a target-language community and make connections to similar information in a documentary about a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community; listen to determine how elements of music, such as lyrics, rhythm, tempo, and beat, reflect the heritage of a particular target-language community; view audio-visual media and identify information indicating the status of the target language around the world*)

Teacher prompts: “In the clip you have just seen, what reminds you of your own community? How does learning about different family customs help you react positively to other cultures?” “How is a community represented by its music?”

A3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

using information from oral texts in the target language, identify and demonstrate an understanding of sociolinguistic conventions used in a variety of situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., compare the level of formality used by speakers of various ages in a country where the target language is spoken; after listening to an interview with an athlete, a politician, or a musician, identify words and phrases related to the occupation of the interviewee; listen to target-language commercials to identify expressions that attempt to persuade the listener to do or buy something; distinguish between some regional dialects and identify their variations in pronunciation and accent; view a news broadcast to identify target-language words that are borrowed from other languages; after listening to a target-language poem or rap, identify some idiomatic expressions; after viewing a television show or a documentary, identify and describe some sociolinguistic conventions related to making purchases and bargaining in a target-language community*)

Teacher prompts: “How did the level of formality differ with the age of the speakers? Did you expect to find more or fewer differences? Why?” “What features of a speaker’s pronunciation might help you identify the region where he or she learned the target language?”

B. SPEAKING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Speaking to Communicate:** communicate information and ideas orally in the target language, using a range of speaking strategies, appropriate language structures, and level-appropriate language suited to the purpose and audience;
- B2. Speaking to Interact:** participate in spoken interactions in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- B3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their spoken communications in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

B1.1 Using Oral Communication Strategies:

identify a range of speaking strategies and use them to express themselves clearly and coherently in the target language for various purposes and to a variety of audiences (e.g., *when planning an oral presentation, create an outline of key ideas and supporting details associated with their topic; record, listen to, and make adjustments to a presentation before delivering it; while delivering a presentation, use non-verbal cues such as gestures, facial expressions, and eye contact to help convey the message; use pauses to build drama and suspense in a role play; compile and refer to a personal lexicon of expressions and phrases that are helpful in a variety of speaking contexts; vary sentence structure when speaking to enhance the connections between ideas*)

Teacher prompts: “In this recording of your own presentation, listen to both the content of your message and the way you expressed it. What do you think needs to be revised?” “What effect does it have on the imagination of your audience if you pause at a key moment during a role play? Where might pauses be most effective in your scenario?”

B1.2 Producing Oral Communications:

produce rehearsed, some detailed, and spontaneous messages in the target language to communicate information and ideas about a variety of academic and personally relevant topics, with

contextual, auditory, and visual support as appropriate (e.g., *deliver a presentation on the protection of personal information in the context of e-banking or another technology, using visual aids and notes; present a critique of a graphic novel, film, video game, or electronic device; create and present a commercial to persuade people to buy locally produced food; in a group discussion, explain the significance of a personal, cultural, or historical item or tradition; deliver an oral report on the impact of diet on health, such as a report comparing the healthful aspects of traditional and contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit diets*)

Teacher prompts: “What details might you add to your critique to make your opinion more convincing?” “What are some benefits to the consumer of buying locally produced food? What are some disadvantages? How might you address any disadvantages and persuade your audience that the benefits are more important?”

B1.3 Speaking with Fluency:

speak with a smooth pace, appropriate intonation, and standard pronunciation in rehearsed and spontaneous communications in the target language about academic and familiar topics (e.g., *accurately pronounce difficult words when participating in a readers’ theatre; recite a memorized poem with appropriate expression; vary intonation and pacing when delivering a presentation about a researched topic; express personal preferences with ease in a conversation with a peer*)

Teacher prompt: “As you prepare to recite the poem, think about the most dramatic moments.

How will you change your delivery at those points? What are the most reflective moments? How will you express them?"

B1.4 Applying Language Knowledge: use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their meaning clearly in the target language

B2. Speaking to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 Using Conversation Strategies: identify and use a range of conversation strategies to suit a variety of formal and informal situations while participating in simple and some detailed spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., rephrase their message when the other participants in group work have not understood; use non-verbal cues such as facial expressions and gestures to clarify their meaning during a class discussion; acknowledge the contributions of others before expressing their own opinions during group work; ask questions to encourage others to share their thoughts; offer alternative suggestions or opinions during a debate*)

Teacher prompts: "How might you clarify your message, either verbally or non-verbally, when your listeners have not understood something?" "What are some phrases you might use to acknowledge other speakers when you are working in a group?"

B2.2 Interacting: engage in structured and spontaneous spoken interactions in the target language about academic and familiar topics, with teacher modelling and support as appropriate (*e.g., offer and respond to invitations, compliments, and apologies; share ideas and opinions in a group discussion about a film; role-play an interview with a newcomer to Canada; exchange ideas with a peer about a topic under study; with a peer, role-play a conversation at a party; defend a point of view in a debate about the protection of animal habitats; provide meaningful feedback in response to a peer's presentation on a social issue such as bullying; role-play inquiring about the price, availability, and/or types of items for sale in a variety of locations, such as a department store, farmers' market, or street vendor*)

Teacher prompts: "Imagine you are at a party and see someone you haven't spoken to in a long time. How would you open the conversation? What kinds of questions might you ask?" "As you begin your debate, remember that you

will have to defend your arguments. What phrases might you use to acknowledge a peer's disagreement and then support your own view?"

B2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after speaking to communicate effectively;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as speakers, and plan steps they can take to improve their speaking skills (*e.g., keep a personal journal to express preferences about the graphic organizers they use to prepare for speaking; identify the peer feedback they found most helpful in improving an oral presentation; describe their use of strategies to refine the delivery of their speech; discuss the effectiveness of setting goals to improve oral communication*)

Teacher prompts: "What aspects of the feedback you received about your presentation did you find helpful? What would you do differently next time?" "What strategy do you find most effective in helping you to refine your spoken delivery? In what way?"

B3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 Intercultural Awareness: communicate information orally in the target language about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., deliver a presentation on the lifelong benefits of learning another language and exploring the complexities of various cultures; with a partner, role-play an interview with a significant historical, scientific, socio-political, or literary figure from a target-language community to explain his or her contributions to the community and/or to the world; present a critique of a target-language film or cultural performance; describe a cultural event in a country or region where the target language is spoken, explaining its importance to the local community; with a peer, compare their own community with one presented in a target-language film or video; describe the economic factors underlying differences between the cost of goods in Ontario and the cost of similar goods in target-language communities*)

Teacher prompts: "What questions would you like to ask this person? What was his or her unique achievement? What do you think others would like to find out about him or her?" "What connections did you make between your

community and the one shown in the video? What differences did you note? What connections did your partner find and share?”

B3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., incorporate regional expressions into a role play or a presentation; identify and describe some alternatives to standard vocabulary, such as dialect variations; use acceptable body language, physical proximity, and gestures when addressing a culturally diverse audience; conduct research and report on expressions*

of greeting and leave taking favoured by adolescents in target-language communities; use the appropriate level of formality to address people in an academic, a personal, a community, or a workplace setting)

Teacher prompts: “Can you share some examples of target-language expressions that adolescents use? How are they similar to or different from expressions that you use yourself?” “How do you address someone whom you do not know in a target-language community in order to ask for information or help?” “How does a shopper’s choice of language change depending on whether a purchase has a fixed or a negotiable price?”

C. READING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading Comprehension:** determine meaning in a variety of texts in the target language, using a range of reading comprehension strategies;
- C2. Purpose, Form, and Style:** identify the purpose(s), characteristics, and aspects of style of a variety of adapted and authentic text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms;
- C3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading Comprehension

By the end of this course, students will:

C1.1 Using Reading Comprehension Strategies:

identify a range of reading comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after reading to understand simple texts and some complex adapted and authentic texts in the target language, in various reading contexts (e.g., *preview vocabulary to become familiar with new words; use prior knowledge and experience to predict the topic before reading, and ask questions during and after reading to test the accuracy of their predictions; draw on personal experience to help them understand the opinions expressed in a text; refer to a variety of visual cues in a text to help them interpret its message; use their knowledge of similar text forms to make inferences; read beyond an unfamiliar word or phrase to infer its meaning from the overall sense of the text; create a list of questions to clarify their understanding of key ideas; make notes while reading to record important or interesting ideas*)

Teacher prompts: “How did previewing new vocabulary improve your understanding as you read the text?” “How does your knowledge of this text form affect the way you read it?”

C1.2 Reading for Meaning:

demonstrate an understanding of information and ideas in a variety of texts in the target language, including simple texts and some complex adapted and authentic texts, with teacher support as appropriate (e.g., *restate the message of a graphic novel*

and/or recount events described in the text; describe the personality of a fictional character, judging from his or her words and actions and from what other characters reveal; summarize key ideas in an article on climate change; make an object or follow a route to an undisclosed location after reading instructions from a peer; read about the benefits of learning the target language and present the information to the class; create an itinerary and a budget for an overseas vacation, using information from target-language websites)

Teacher prompt: “What evidence did you find to support various key ideas presented in the article?”

C1.3 Reading with Fluency:

read texts in the target language that contain familiar vocabulary and expressions at a sufficient rate and with sufficient ease to demonstrate that they understand the overall sense of the text (e.g., *adjust pace, tone, and emphasis while reading aloud, according to text features such as punctuation, italics, or bold type; smoothly articulate words related to personal and academic interests; communicate the emotions suggested by a text by reading with expression; use emphasis and phrasing for dramatic effect while reading to an audience*)

Teacher prompt: “What emotions does this text imply? How can you communicate them as you read? How does that help your audience?”

C1.4 Developing Vocabulary: use a range of vocabulary-acquisition strategies before, during, and after reading to determine or confirm the meaning of new, unfamiliar, or recently learned words (e.g., *use knowledge of etymology and related words to infer the meaning of unfamiliar words; consult online dictionaries to broaden their vocabulary related to a specific subject or area of study; construct a mind map to help them remember terms and phrases related to the topic of a text they are reading; substitute a word that would make sense in the same context to help them decode an unfamiliar word; identify words borrowed from other languages to confirm their meaning; conduct research to identify the meaning of jargon and slang encountered in a blog*)

Teacher prompts: “What does the prefix of this word tell you about its meaning? What does the suffix tell you?” “What familiar word could you substitute for this new one to make sense of the sentence?”

C2. Purpose, Form, and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 Purposes and Characteristics of Text

Forms: identify the purpose(s) and characteristics of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how the characteristics help communicate the meaning (e.g., *human, divine, or animal characters, often possessing special knowledge or talents, imaginatively represent aspects of a traditional belief system in a folk tale; the interplay of images and words conveys the plot and characterization in a graphic novel; setting, plot, and characterization work together in a short story or novel to depict the significance of imagined experiences; photographs, status updates, and likes and dislikes on social networking sites help friends keep in touch; photographs and descriptions of sites and cultural traditions in a travel guide help tourists choose a vacation destination*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways do the images in a graphic novel complement the written text?” “What is the purpose of selecting likes and dislikes on a social networking site?”

C2.2 Text Features and Elements of Style:

identify some features and stylistic elements of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how they help convey the meaning (e.g., *rhyme, personification, and metaphor emphasize particular ideas in a poem; a table of contents, lists, sidebars, and links to related topics allow the user to navigate an online encyclopedia; links in a*

website lead the user to related information; dialogue and descriptive words help the reader visualize characters in a work of fiction; diagrams and illustrations give the reader visual cues in a non-fiction book)

Teacher prompts: “What idea is the poet trying to emphasize in selecting this metaphor? How do you know?” “Can you identify some of the navigation features in this online encyclopedia?” “Why are illustrations an important element in a non-fiction text?”

C2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after reading to understand texts;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as readers, and plan steps they can take to improve their reading skills (e.g., *keep a reading log to record reflections on how often and how well they use various strategies; review their reading log to set goals for improving their use of particular strategies, such as rereading to find information they may have overlooked or synthesizing ideas while reading a longer text; plan to read a variety of works of fiction to expand their vocabulary and fluency*)

Teacher prompt: “What strategies do you use to synthesize ideas while reading a longer text? How could you improve your use of them?”

C3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from a variety of texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., *read about the benefits of learning another language, such as opportunities for careers, summer jobs, travel, and making friends, and identify the ones they find most personally relevant; create a multimedia presentation to highlight cultural aspects of different countries or regions, using information from travel brochures; research a well-known target-language speaker, and discuss their findings in an audio-visual presentation; find out about language exchanges and share the information with the class; identify vocabulary that reflects the cultural identity of the author of a text*)

Teacher prompts: “What details in the travel brochures influenced your opinion of this region?” “What do you think are the biggest benefits of going on a language exchange? Where would you like to go on exchange? Why?”

C3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify, in level-appropriate texts in the target language, examples of sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., compare the use of slang and/or colloquialisms and the use of the standard target-language form in posters, cartoons, graphic novels, or advertisements; identify regional vocabulary in a children's story depicting a cultural celebration; skim a variety of texts to identify formulas to express gratitude, make excuses, or extend invitations in different target-language communities; skim headlines and advertisements in an online target-language regional newspaper to identify vocabulary unique to the region; discuss similarities and differences in the language used in song lyrics and poems from two regions*)

Teacher prompt: “In what contexts have you found slang in target-language texts? Would you expect to find slang in these text forms in your own community?”

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form:** write texts in the target language for different purposes and audiences, using a variety of forms and knowledge of language structures and conventions of the written language appropriate for this course;
- D2. The Writing Process:** use the stages of the writing process – including pre-writing, producing drafts, revising, editing, and publishing – to develop and organize content, clarify ideas and expression, correct errors, and present their written work in the target language effectively;
- D3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their written work in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form

By the end of this course, students will:

D1.1 Identifying Purpose and Audience:

determine, with support from the teacher, their purpose for writing and the audience for texts in the target language they plan to create (e.g., to produce a short report introducing a real or an imagined new technology; to highlight the environmental impact of different kinds of transportation in a community campaign poster; to convince their families to visit another city or country by creating a travel brochure; to compose a poem or song lyrics reflecting the theme and/or emotions expressed in a short story they have read; to express personal feelings in a journal entry; to create a set of instructions explaining how to use a product; to create an itinerary and a budget for a trip to volunteer in a country where the target language is spoken)

Teacher prompts: “What is the primary purpose of your report: to encourage people to use the technology or to advise them about its potential problems? Who is the intended audience?”
“How should the language on a community campaign poster differ from the language you might use when writing to a friend?”

- D1.2 Writing in a Variety of Forms:** write a variety of level-appropriate texts in the target language, applying their knowledge of some structural and stylistic elements of each form

(e.g., a short article about the benefits of learning international languages; a short biography of an important Canadian historical figure, such as a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit individual; a résumé tailored for a job of personal interest; a multimedia text demonstrating the benefits of daily physical activity; a critique of a work of art or a dance by their favourite artist or choreographer; a blog review of a television show or movie; a social media report about an economic issue currently in the news in a target-language community; a visa application for a country where the target language is spoken)

Teacher prompts: “How does repeating key words in a multimedia text help convey the intended message?” “What linguistic elements can you include in a critique to appeal to and affect the reader?”

- D1.3 Applying Language Knowledge:** use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their intended meaning in written work in the target language

D2. The Writing Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1 Generating, Developing, and Organizing Content:** generate, develop, and organize ideas for writing in the target language, using a range of pre-writing strategies and resources, during

modelled, shared, guided, and independent writing activities (e.g., use rapid writing to record the key ideas in a read-aloud or shared reading text before writing a summary; keep a journal of possible writing topics; create a storyboard to help them structure a narrative before writing; sort ideas into logical order for an informational paragraph; refer to peer and teacher feedback to narrow the focus of a writing task; consult print and online resources to expand their knowledge of a topic)

Teacher prompts: “What is the most important idea you want to convey about your topic? Will you begin your text with that idea and then explain it, or conclude with the main idea as the outcome of other key points? Why?” “What gaps can you identify in the information you have about the topic? What sources can you consult to expand your knowledge before writing?”

D2.2 Drafting and Revising: plan and produce drafts in the target language, and revise their writing using a variety of teacher-directed and independently selected strategies (e.g., vary sentence structure to make their writing clearer and more interesting; add details to support, emphasize, or qualify ideas; identify words and expressions they use frequently and integrate new vocabulary into their text to avoid repetition and enrich the language; refer to a list of teacher- and student-generated questions as a guide when revising the structure of their writing; annotate their rough draft before revising; reread their draft to determine whether ideas and supporting details are important, interesting, and clearly related to the purpose or topic; consult a variety of classroom and online resources when editing)

Teacher prompts: “As you revise your draft, try shortening some sentences, combining others, and then rereading. What effect does this sentence variety have on you as a reader?” “As you review your draft, what repeated words or phrases do you notice? What effect does the repetition have on the reader? What synonyms or ways to rephrase your ideas can you think of?”

D2.3 Producing Finished Work: make improvements to enhance the clarity and readability of their written work in the target language, and use a range of elements of effective presentation to produce a polished product for publication (e.g., create computer-generated charts to summarize findings; add headings and subheadings to create sections in a report; add a glossary of specialized vocabulary; format work appropriately for the text form, such as putting the steps of a procedure

into a numbered list; position graphic elements appropriately within the text to enhance the clarity of the message)

Teacher prompt: “How could you position the visual elements of your work differently within the text to help the reader better understand your message?”

D2.4 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after writing; (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as writers, and plan steps they can take to improve their writing skills (e.g., keep a portfolio of strategies that were successful during the writing process; identify and describe differences in their strengths as writers in the target language and in their first language; describe how they assess the usefulness of peer feedback; plan to keep a writing reflection journal; after a writing activity, complete a self-assessment in order to plan next steps)

Teacher prompt: “How can you determine whether the peer feedback you received is valid? Which aspect of your message did your peer focus on: the content or its expression? How can you assess whether the comments were objective?”

D3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 Intercultural Awareness: in their written work in the target language, communicate information about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., write a paragraph comparing the health care systems of Canada and a country where the target language is spoken; summarize some interesting and significant facts about a target-language community in a blog entry; create a storyboard outlining a historical event in a country where the target language is spoken; write the text for a game of general knowledge about significant individuals, including indigenous individuals, from various target-language communities; write and illustrate a description of a cultural artefact, explaining its significance; write an online review of the local cuisine in a region where the target language is spoken; create a flyer about the effects of climate change in a country where the target language is spoken, describing efforts to mitigate or adapt to these effects; prepare an information text

to help Ontario students understand and respect cultural norms when completing community service or volunteer work in a country where the target language is spoken)

Teacher prompts: “What similarities and differences did you find between health care systems? Which similarities or differences surprise you?” “What is unique about this artefact? What is significant about it?”

D3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in their written work in the target language (*e.g., create a comic strip that includes some idiomatic expressions specific to a country or region; use the appropriate level of formality in a letter requesting a job interview; write an e-mail to a friend using expressions from a specific region where the target language is spoken; write a description of a cultural food festival that incorporates words or expressions related to food and meals in different target-language communities*)

Teacher prompt: “How might you distinguish between a letter to a friend and a letter to accompany your résumé? What are the differences in content or style, or both?”